14 Connecting to systems with Alpakka

This chapter covers

- Reading from and writing to Kafka
- Reading from and writing to CSV

Alpakka is a project that implements multiple connectors that allow you to interact with different technologies in a reactive streaming way according to the principles of the Reactive Streams project (www.reactive-streams.org). For example, you can read from a Kafka topic with an asynchronous stream with no blocking backpressure.

This chapter covers two of the most commonly used connectors, Kafka and CSV. The CSV Alpakka connector can be classified as *finite streams* because it ends after the file is read. The Kafka Alpakka connector, on the other hand, is an example of an infinite stream where there is an open connection to a topic that can produce records at any time.

Alpakka Kafka has an extensive API; most of this chapter is dedicated to it. The rest of the chapter is dedicated to CSV, which has a relatively simple API.

NOTE The source code for this chapter is available at www.manning.com/books/akka-in-action-second-edition or https://github.com/franciscolopez sancho/akka-